Macacna Deragun Lucman

Colonel Macacna "Abdulwahid" Deragun Lucman was a Filipino Muslim military and police officer who served in the Philippine Constabulary (PC) and the Philippine National Police (PNP) across a career spanning 27 years. Born into a Mindanao shaped by cultural pride, political tension, and armed conflict, he rose through the ranks on the strength of competitive achievement, battlefield grit, and a deep sense of duty to both his institution and his community.

He is remembered not only for his decorated combat record but for something rarer: the kind of quiet, persistent leadership that showed up after the firefights, in the barangay halls, the college campuses, and the crowded alleys of the city, long after most soldiers had hung up their boots.

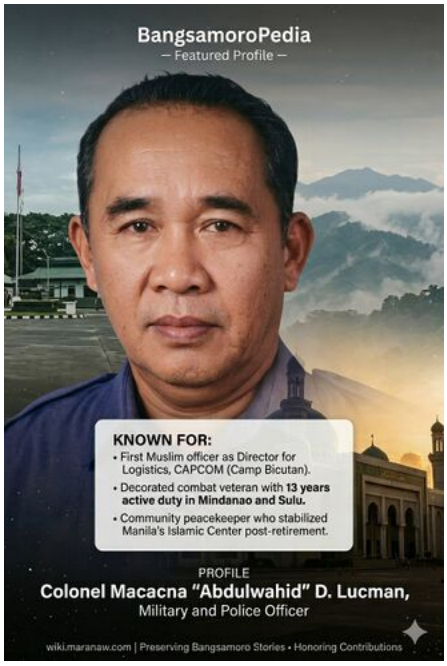
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BACKGROUND

Colonel Lucman came of age at a time when Mindanao was anything but quiet. The region was in the thick of decades of conflict, with Moro communities caught between armed movements, state military operations, and the everyday pressures of living under policies that did not always reflect their realities. Growing up Bangsamoro in that environment meant carrying a particular kind of weight, one that demanded both cultural rootedness and a willingness to engage with larger national institutions.

Colonel Macacna "Abdulwahid" Deragun Lucman



Full Name

Macacna "Abdulwahid" Deragun Lucman

Also Known As

Colonel Lucman; Abdulwahid Lucman

Ethnicity / Community

Bangsamoro (Lanao region)

Education

Bachelor of Arts in Political Science, University of Manila (1969)

Military Branch

Philippine Constabulary (PC) / Philippine National Police (PNP), Armed Forces of the Philippines

He chose engagement. Rather than turn away from the Philippine state, he moved toward it, not in spite of who he was, but very much as who he was: a Muslim man from Mindanao who believed that service and community were not in conflict with each other.

That posture, principled participation in a system that was imperfect and sometimes hostile, would define everything he did over the next several decades.

EDUCATION

Lucman earned his Bachelor of Arts in Political Science from the University of Manila in 1969. The choice of discipline was fitting: political science is, at its core, the study of power, governance, and the relationship between citizens and the state. For a young Bangsamoro man navigating a country with deep questions about who belongs and who gets to lead, it was the right lens.

His years at the University of Manila also planted the roots of fraternal connections that would last a lifetime. He became a life member of the Alpha Phi Omega fraternity (Tau Chapter), a service-oriented organization with deep ties to the scouting movement, as well as Kappa Beta Phi.

MILITARY AND POLICE CAREER

Entry and Commission

In 1970, just a year after finishing his degree, Lucman took on one of the most competitive entry points into the Philippine military establishment: the qualifying examination for Regular Officers in the Philippine Constabulary (PC), then an arm of the Armed Forces of the Philippines (AFP). It was a punishing field. Over 800 applicants sat for the exam nationwide. Only 114 passed. Lucman ranked No. 20 among them.

That ranking earned him a commission as a 2nd Lieutenant in the PC, and with it, the start of a career that would take him from the jungles of Mindanao to the halls of the Capital Command in Taguig.

Rank

Colonel

Years of Service

27 years (commissioned 1970)

Entry Rank

2nd Lieutenant, Philippine Constabulary (1970)

Areas of Service

Central Mindanao, Tawi-Tawi, Basilan, Sulu, Zamboanga City, Lanao del Sur, Maguindanao, Metro Manila (CAPCOM)

Notable Positions

Director for Logistics, Capital Command (CAPCOM); Provincial Director, Lanao del Sur PNPO; Provincial Director, Maguindanao PNPO; Chief of Police, Malabang, Lanao del Sur; Regional Adjutant, RECOM 9, Zamboanga City

Spouse

Bae Norhaina Macabato Alonto

Fraternal Memberships

Alpha Phi Omega (Tau Chapter, University of Manila); Kappa Beta Phi; LAMUSPROF; Bayang United Youth Fraternity; Crossed Swords Fraternity; Free & Accepted Masons of the Philippines, Lodge No. 148 Noli Me Tangere (Ermita, Manila, est. 1988)

Death

Passed away after a lingering illness (date unverified)

Notability

First Muslim officer in recent memory to serve as Director for Logistics at the Capital Command (CAPCOM) since its activation in 1967; decorated combat veteran with 13 years of active duty in Mindanao and the Sulu Archipelago; community peacekeeper at Manila's Islamic Center post-retirement

Known For

Bridging Bangsamoro military service and civilian community work; leading the bloodless recovery of a kidnapped MSU director in 1976; maintaining order at MSU Marawi (1997) and at

Manila's Islamic Center during his retirement years

Combat Years in Mindanao

For 13 years, Lucman served in active combat roles across some of the most volatile provinces in the country: Central Mindanao, Tawi-Tawi, Basilan, Sulu, and Zamboanga City. These were not desk postings. The Moro insurgency was at its peak in the 1970s and early 1980s, and officers like Lucman were deployed into situations where the margin between life and death was thin.

His record from this period includes direct combat engagements against armed groups, hostage recovery operations, and extended deployments in areas where ambushes were a routine hazard.

What made his position unusual, and in many ways remarkable, was that he was a Muslim officer serving in operations that were often directed against Moro armed factions. That was not a simple thing to navigate. It required a clear sense of institutional duty alongside a personal compass that kept him grounded in who he was.

Capital Command (CAPCOM)

Later in his career, Lucman was assigned to the Capital Command (CAPCOM) at Camp Bicutan, Taguig, one of the more prestigious postings within the AFP structure. There he served on the general staff as Director for Logistics, a senior administrative and operational role.

The significance of that appointment goes beyond the title. He became the first Muslim officer in recent memory to hold that position since CAPCOM's activation in 1967. In an institution that has historically been dominated by officers from other parts of the country and other faith communities, that milestone mattered: not as a token, but as evidence that Bangsamoro professionals could and did reach the upper tiers of the national security apparatus.

Provincial Directorships

His regional assignments included serving as Provincial Director for the Lanao del Sur PNPO, based at Camp Bagong Amai Pakpak in Marawi City, and later as Provincial Director in Maguindanao. These were leadership postings in provinces where the PNP's role was layered and complicated: keeping peace in communities still raw from decades of armed conflict, navigating relationships between state forces, local government, and Moro constituencies.

He also served as Regional Adjutant for Regional Command 9 (RECOM 9) in Zamboanga City from 1981 to 1982, an administrative and coordination role that recognized his organizational competence as much as his field experience.

Earlier, in 1981, he served as Chief of Police in Malabang, Lanao del Sur, maintaining civil order during the final years of martial law. That posting coincided with active operations by the 25th Infantry Battalion, and his role was to keep the community from fracturing further under that pressure.

DECORATIONS AND AWARDS

Colonel Lucman's award record reflects both his courage in the field and his effectiveness in administrative command. Key decorations include:

Bronze Cross Medal

Awarded for heroism during a 1980 encounter with armed terrorists in Barangay Lower Kidama, Parang, Maguindanao.

Military Merit Medal with Spear Device (twice)
Awarded twice for bravery in combat: first for actions against armed groups in Basilan in 1983, and earlier for actions against the Tonda Force in Lanao del Sur in 1972.

Military Merit Medal with Anahaw Leaf (twice)
Awarded twice for administrative excellence during his service as Regional Adjutant in RECOM 9, Zamboanga City (1981-1982).

Wounded Military Personnel Medal
Received following his 1972 engagement against the Tonda Force in Lanao del Sur, where he sustained combat injuries.

Kagitingan Badge as Commander
Recognized his leadership under fire.

Campaign Ribbons
He carried ribbons for the Sulu Campaign, Mindanao Campaign, and anti-dissident operations, along with various commendations and plaques from different commands.

KEY ACCOMPLISHMENTS

The 1976 Hostage Recovery

One of the most dramatic episodes in Lucman's career came in 1976, when Mindanao State University director Eduardo Ulindang was kidnapped. Lucman led the recovery operation and secured Ulindang's safe release without the payment of any ransom. In a period when such situations routinely ended badly or dragged on indefinitely, that outcome stood out. It reflected not just tactical skill but the kind of trust and community intelligence that only comes from an officer who is genuinely known and respected in the region.

MSU Marawi Campus Stabilization (1997)

Decades later, in 1997, Lucman was called on again when unrest broke out on the main campus of Mindanao State University in Marawi City. He helped restore peace and order on campus, a role that drew on both his authority and his standing as someone the Marawi community recognized as one of their own.

Islamic Center, Manila

From the late 1990s onward, one of Lucman's most sustained contributions was in Quiapo's Islamic Center in Manila, a dense, historically significant migrant community that had been established in the 1960s by prominent Moro leaders as a base for students and families from Mindanao and Sulu coming to the capital.

By the time Lucman became a fixture there, the area had grown complex and difficult: overcrowded, under-resourced, and increasingly touched by drug trafficking and other forms of disorder. He moved in not as a passive presence but as an active force for stability, pushing back against drug lords and criminal networks, enforcing community discipline, and working to make the enclave cleaner and more orderly.

Accounts from the community describe him as someone who clashed directly with criminal elements, willing to put himself in the middle of dangerous situations even in retirement. He kept at it until his health began to fail.

FAMILY

He married **Bae Norhaina Macabato Alonto**, who served as Barangay Chairwoman of Barangay 648 (Zone 67, District VI, Manila), the barangay that encompasses the Islamic Center. Her community leadership complemented his; together, they represented a kind of dual presence in a migrant enclave that needed both security and civic stewardship.

The Alonto name carries significant weight in Bangsamoro political and social history, and Bae Norhaina's community work in Manila kept those connections alive in an urban setting far from Mindanao.

CIVIC AND FRATERNAL LIFE

Beyond his military affiliations, Lucman maintained a wide network of fraternal and civic memberships throughout his life. In addition to Alpha Phi Omega and Kappa Beta Phi from his university years, he held life membership in:

- **LAMUSPROF** (Lanao Muslim Professionals), connecting him to the network of Maranao and Lanao-origin professionals across the country
- **Bayang United Youth Fraternity**, a fraternal organization with roots in the Bangsamoro community
- **Crossed Swords Fraternity**, an exclusive organization for AFP officer candidates and officers

In 1988, he joined the **Free and Accepted Masons of the Philippines**, specifically Lodge No. 148 Noli Me Tangere in Ermita, Manila. His membership in Masonry, alongside his identity as a practicing Muslim, reflects the kind of pluralist engagement that characterized his whole life: building bridges across different traditions without abandoning his own.

LEGACY

Colonel Lucman's life resists easy categorization. He was a Muslim military man who served loyally in institutions that were sometimes in tension with Moro communities. He was a decorated combat officer who spent as much of his energy on civic peacekeeping as on battlefield operations. He was a Mindanaoan who became a fixture in Manila's most prominent Muslim community.

What ties it all together is a consistent commitment to order, dignity, and community: not order imposed from outside, but the kind built from inside, by someone who understood the people he served and who they were.

His path, from a top-ranking PC examiner to provincial director to neighborhood guardian, illustrates something the broader story of the Philippines too often overlooks: the role that Bangsamoro professionals have played in building and maintaining the country's institutions, often at great personal cost, and often without the recognition those contributions deserve.

His medals capture the risks. His legacy lives in the communities that are safer, more stable, and more dignified because he was there.

EDITORIAL NOTES

(Not for publication. For editorial reference only.)

- The source document is described as "online deep research" attributed to Grok (an AI tool). No primary sources (official service records, PNP/AFP personnel files, family testimonies, or academic references) are cited. All factual claims in this article should be treated as requiring independent verification before publication.
- The exact birth date, place of birth, and dates of death are not provided in the source. These should be sourced from family or official records before the infobox is finalized.
- The phrase "first Muslim officer in recent memory" as Director for Logistics at CAPCOM is carried over from the source as written. The qualifier "in recent memory" is vague; consider verifying or refining this claim.
- Eduardo Ulindang's title ("MSU director") is as stated in the source. His exact position at MSU and details of the 1976 kidnapping should be independently verified.
- The Alonto connection (Bae Norhaina Macabato Alonto) is noted but not elaborated on in the source. If verifiable, a brief note on her family lineage could add context, given the significance of the Alonto name in Bangsamoro history.
- The Tonda Force, mentioned in connection with the 1972 combat engagement in Lanao del Sur, is not further described in the source. Editorial research into this group is recommended.
- Cause and exact date of death are unverified. The article uses "passed away after a lingering illness" per the source.
- LAMUSPROF's full name (Lanao Muslim Professionals) is assumed based on common usage. Confirm formal name.

SEE ALSO

- Bangsamoro
- Mindanao State University
- Philippine Constabulary
- Philippine National Police
- Islamic Center, Manila
- Lanao del Sur
- Marawi City
- Camp Bagong Amai Pakpak
- Capital Command (CAPCOM)

REFERENCES

- Source: Profile submitted by **Rama L. Datudacula.** (https://www.facebook.com/rama.l.datudacula)]

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